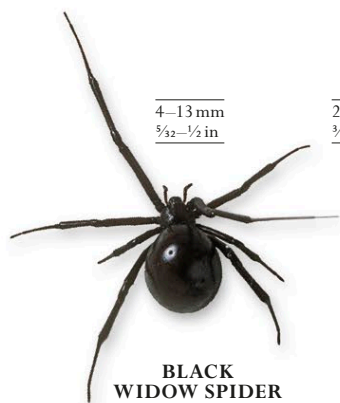




4–13 mm
3/32–1/2 in

BLACK WIDOW SPIDER
Latrodectus mactans
F: Theridiidae

A small spider with venom unusually dangerous to humans, females of this N. American species frequently eat the smaller male after mating.



2–3 cm
3/4–1 1/4 in

TARANTULA WOLF SPIDER
Lycosa tarantula
F: Lycosidae

This species is the only true tarantula: a large member of the wolf spider family from Mediterranean Europe, not to be confused with hairy-bodied “bird-eaters”.



5–8 mm
3/16–5/16 in

EUROPEAN WOLF SPIDER
Pardosa amentata
F: Lycosidae

A typical wolf spider, this furry brown spider hunts over ground without a web. Females carry an egg sac and young ride on the mother's back.



NURSERY WEB SPIDER
Pisaura mirabilis
F: Pisauridae

Females of this Eurasian spider carry their egg sac beneath the body by their jaws, before weaving a nursery “tent” of silk to protect hatching young.

egg sac carried by jaws
1–1.5 cm
3/8–1/2 in



1.2 cm
3/8 in

CAVE SPIDER
Meta menardi
F: Tetragnathidae

Many spiders of the genus *Meta*, such as this European species, inhabit caves, where they suspend their drop-shaped egg sacs.



7–18 mm
7/32–7/16 in

WATER SPIDER
Argyroneta aquatica
F: Dictynidae

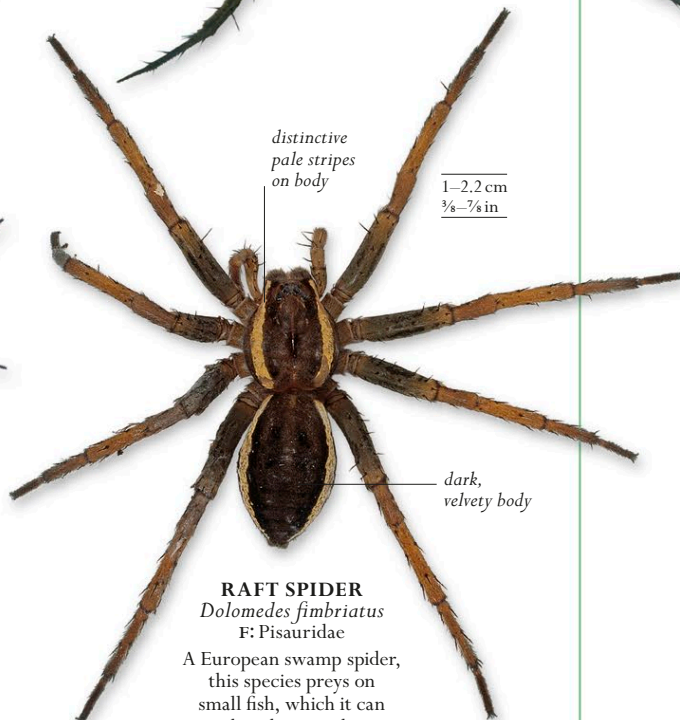
The only routinely aquatic spider, this Eurasian pond species builds a submerged, air-filled chamber, inside which it eats its prey, including small fish.



1–1.8 cm
3/8–3/4 in

GIANT HOUSE SPIDER
Eratigena duellica
F: Agelenidae

A member of a group of spiders that build sheet webs with tubular retreats, this species frequents buildings across the northern hemisphere.



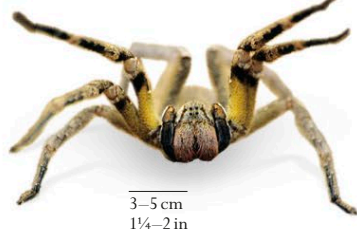
distinctive pale stripes on body

1–2.2 cm
3/8–7/8 in

dark, velvety body

RAFT SPIDER
Dolomedes fimbriatus
F: Pisauridae

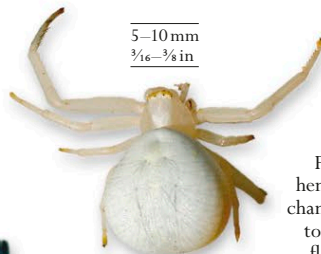
A European swamp spider, this species preys on small fish, which it can attract by vibrating the water surface with its legs.



3–5 cm
1 1/4–2 in

BRAZILIAN WANDERING SPIDER
Phoneutria nigriventer
F: Ctenidae

Wandering spiders get their name from their nocturnal roaming habits. This species from Brazilian forests is believed to be the world's most venomous spider.



5–10 mm
3/16–3/8 in

CRAB SPIDER
Misumena vatia
F: Thomisidae

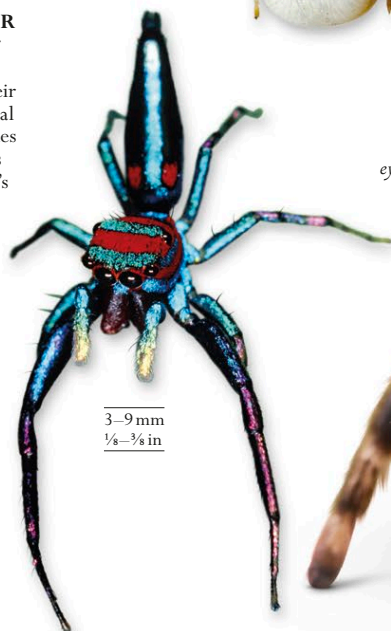
Females of this northern hemisphere spider can slowly change their colour from white to yellow for camouflage in flowers before ambushing nectar-feeding insects.



2–3 cm
3/4–1 1/4 in

BROWN HUNTSMAN SPIDER
Heteropoda venatoria
F: Sparassidae

Widespread throughout tropical and subtropical regions, this large but harmless spider is sometimes welcomed in homes for preying on cockroaches.



3–9 mm
1/8–3/8 in

ELEGANT JUMPING SPIDER
Chrysilla lauta
F: Salticidae

Jumping spiders are especially diverse in the tropics. Many, such as this E. Asian species, are strikingly coloured, sometimes to aid communication.



5–7 mm
3/16–7/32 in

BROWN JUMPING SPIDER
Evarcha arcuata
F: Salticidae

This Eurasian grassland species is one of thousands of species of jumping spiders with acute binocular vision and complex courtship behaviour.

thickened front legs

large forward-facing eyes for judging distance